



NASA's Sun mission

NASA made an announcement about the Solar Probe Plus mission, which aims to explore the sun's atmosphere. <http://dgit.in/ProbePlus>



Bots for minefields

A new type of inexpensive turtlebots could be a great tool to crawl across minefields for safety checks. <http://dgit.in/turtlebots>

ASRock X370 Taichi

A reasonably priced Ryzen board

The ASRock X370 Taichi offers a mix of high quality components and has really outdone itself in the VRM department to aid better overclocking for enthusiasts. With 16-power phases which does seem overkill, you're destined to get a really stable supply of power to help you ramp up your unlocked Ryzen processors. The default BIOS has everything toned down and did have a few memory compatibility issues which were resolved with the P2.20 BIOS. But should you feel the need to have more parameters to play around with then the P2.30 version really opens things up with a lot more. We used a



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3200 MHz G.Skill Trident kit as well as a Corsair Vengeance 3200 MHz kit and both were able to hit 2933 MHz but 3200 MHz was still unattainable. We

like that the PCIe x16 slots are placed apart to accommodate triple-slot graphics cards as more and more

manufacturers have gone down that road. Another thing that stands out with the X370 are the SATA slots, there are 10 of them so it's unlikely you'll ever run out of slots for your storage needs. However, we do seem to have a bit of empty space on the rear I/O. Being an X370 board, there's no need for display connectors but that space could have been better utilised by adding a few more USB 3.0/3.1 ports or perhaps another Ethernet port with teaming support. For the price, the ASRock X370 Taichi makes for a pretty well-rounded motherboard without all the RGB madness, and hence gets our approval.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

CHIPSET: AMD X370 | MEMORY SUPPORT: 4x3200(OC)MHz upto 64GB | LAN: Intel i211-AT Gigabit Ethernet | AUDIO: ALC 1220 7.1 | SATA: 10x SATA III | EXPANSION: 3x PCIe x16(x16+x8+x4) | DIMENSIONS (LxWxD): 305 mm x 244 mm | WARRANTY: 3 years.

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BenQ Zowie XL2540

240Hz Gaming Monitor

Built for just one purpose

BenQ seems to have gone with a simple formula while designing the XL2540 which can be summarised with just three words – because we can. Let's start off by saying that the monitor is ridiculously smooth. We sourced a GTX 1080 Ti just so that we could play AAA titles at Full HD in all its glory while letting the FPS counter run loose. It didn't work out at all since most games these days are so broken that they're barely enjoyable. So we turned to eSports titles, since they're better suited and a lot more optimised. CS:GO completely topped out and we can see why this would matter to competitive gaming but where does one

stop seeing the difference? We've played on 144 Hz monitors as well and they're very fluid as well and we found it hard pressed to see the difference. Perhaps the professionals are at a completely different level but our



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mortal eyes could only see so much. The drawback of having such a high refresh rate is that not all panel types can support it so you're stuck with a TN panel. And you know how TN panels have a reputation for washed out colours and poor viewing angles. However, one should remember that these monitors are built for the competitive circuit and a good "movie viewing experience" isn't exactly priority. As for the colour gamut, it scored 99% of the sRGB gamut and 77% of Adobe RGB gamut which are quite good values. Overall, the BenQ Zowie XL2540 is a pricey monitor but good for professional gamers.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

PANEL: TN | SCREEN SIZE: 24.5-inches | RESOLUTION: 1920 x 1080 | REFRESH RATE: 240 Hz | CONNECTORS: DVI-DL, 2x HDMI, DVI 1.2 | AUDIO PASSTHROUGH: Yes | PROFILE CONTROLLER: Yes | CONTRAST RATIO: 1000:1 | RESPONSE TIME: 1ms (GtG) | POWER: 55 W | WEIGHT: 7.5 kg.

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